

Sean McNally, MS, LCAT, MT-BC

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Case studies & live tools: seanmcnallynyc.github.io

Mixed-methods researcher/clinician who turns clinical findings into shipped products, and builds the scalable, lasting infrastructure for others to utilize on their projects. Leading AI integration for a funded NIH R01 at Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center; four years working on qualitative and quantitative research with cancer patients.

EXPERIENCE

Research Music Therapist 2022 – Present

Memorial Sloan Kettering Cancer Center, New York, NY. Remote (Seattle, WA)

AI INTEGRATION & TOOL DEVELOPMENT — MELODY AI SUBSTUDY, VIRTUOSO (R01)

- Diagnosed a recurring “blank page” failure in AI-assisted songwriting through direct clinical observation; built the Lyric Scaffold, targeting a five-minute first draft (*full case study on portfolio*).
- Evaluated ~12 AI music platforms; selected and onboarded Suno as the core intervention tool. Continuing software vendor relationship
- Lead AI integration for VIRTUOSO (NIH R01, 30 participants, multi-site); built a Power BI dashboard for real-time study monitoring.
- Built a closed-code qualitative coding infrastructure (codebook, fidelity-verification script) so a second coder could replicate the analysis without me.

CLINICAL RESEARCH OPERATIONS — MELODY RCT, PRELUDE

- Screened and consented participants under IRB-approved protocols; managed HIPAA-compliant data across MELODY, a 300-participant two-site RCT ([J Clin Oncol, 2026](#)).
- Collected validated patient-reported outcomes (HADS, CLS, IES, FACT-Cog, insomnia), with phone follow-up to keep the dataset complete.
- Co-designed and delivered both arms of PRELUDE, piano instruction vs. a music-attention control, for cancer-related cognitive dysfunction. Maintained ongoing software/hardware vendor relationships: physical shipping workflows, user behavior pattern data

PROGRAM DEVELOPMENT & TRANSLATION

- Built MSK's first outpatient music therapy program from the ground up; scaled from 35 to 220+ sessions a year, reaching self-sustainability.
- Reported study updates & benchmarks to grant funder PCORI and presented subanalysis findings at the Society for Integrative Oncology (2024, 2025). Adapted MELODY's individual treatment protocol into a group format;

Job Coach & Travel Trainer 2014 – 2022

Rebecca School & private families, New York, NY.

- Supported young adults with developmental delays in a variety of capacities including emotional regulation, skill development, & musical engagement in school, at home, and in the community.

METHODS & TOOLS

Qualitative coding & thematic analysis · mixed-methods synthesis · usability/accessibility evaluation · Semi-structured Interviews · Surveys & validated outcome measures · RCT design & IRB/consent · Microsoft suite · AI-assisted prototyping · Redcap · iMotions biometric analysis · Music production · Video editing

EDUCATION & LICENSURE

MS, Music Therapy — SUNY New Paltz | BFA, Film/Video — School of Visual Arts

Licensed Creative Arts Therapist (LCAT), New York · Board-Certified Music Therapist (MT-BC)